

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK & POLICY GUIDE

Comprehensive Operational Standards, Benefits, Leave Regulations & Code of Conduct

Document Version: 4.2 (Annual Revision)

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Target Audience: All Regular Full-Time & Part-Time Staff

Governing Dept: Human Resources

1. LEAVE & TIME-OFF REGULATIONS

1.1 Annual Leave Entitlement & Accrual

Full-time regular employees are entitled to **twenty (20) working days of Paid Annual Leave (Vacation Leave)** per completed calendar year, accrued at a rate of **1.67 days per month** of continuous service. Annual leave is intended to support work-life balance, rest, and personal rejuvenation.

- **Accrual Basis:** Leave accrues on the last calendar day of each working month starting from the employee's date of hire.
- **Probation Period:** New hires may utilize accrued annual leave upon successful completion of their three (3) month probationary period, subject to manager approval.
- **Advance Notice:** Requests exceeding three (3) consecutive business days must be submitted via the HR Portal at least two (2) weeks in advance.

1.2 Key Differences: Annual Leave vs. Sick Leave

While both leave types provide paid absence from work, they serve distinct purposes and are governed by separate governance protocols:

Attribute	Annual Leave (Vacation)	Sick Leave (Medical)
Core Purpose	Rest, recreation, personal travel, and pre-planned family commitments.	Recovery from illness, acute injury, medical treatment, or healthcare appointments.
Annual Allocation	20 working days per calendar year (accrued monthly).	12 paid working days per calendar year (credited upfront on Jan 1).
Advance Notice	Required: Minimum 3–14 days prior notice depending on duration.	Emergency / Same-day notice: Manager must be notified within 2 hours of shift start.
Documentation	None required (standard management approval workflow).	Registered Medical Practitioner Certificate required for absences of 3+ consecutive days.
Carry Forward & Payout	Eligible for rollover up to 10 days; encashable upon separation.	Non-cumulative; lapses at year-end; strictly non-encashable.

1.3 Sick Leave Rules & Procedures

All regular employees receive **twelve (12) days of Paid Sick Leave** per year. Sick leave is allocated to protect employee well-being and maintain a healthy workplace environment.

- **Notification:** In the event of unexpected illness or injury, the employee must notify their immediate supervisor via email/ phone prior to or within two (2) hours of their scheduled shift start time.
- **Medical Certification:** A certified doctor's note or medical fitness certificate is mandatory for any sick leave absence extending to **three (3) or more consecutive days**, or when sick leave directly adjoins a public holiday or weekend.
- **Misuse of Sick Leave:** Using sick leave for non-medical personal tasks constitutes gross misconduct and will trigger disciplinary review.

1.4 Leave Carry-Forward & Encashment Policy

The organization actively encourages employees to utilize their full leave quota within the calendar year. However, where operational constraints prevent full utilization:

CARRY-FORWARD RULES SUMMARY

- **Annual Leave:** Employees may roll over a maximum of **ten (10) unused annual leave days** into the following calendar year. Any accrued balance exceeding 10 days on December 31st will automatically lapse.
- **Carry-Forward Utilization Window:** All carried-forward days must be consumed before **June 30th** of the new year.
- **Sick Leave:** Sick leave days **cannot** be carried forward and reset to zero on December 31st.
- **Separation Encashment:** Upon resignation or termination, unutilized valid annual leave days (up to 20 days max) will be encashed in the Final Settlement at the base salary rate.

1.5 Maternity & Parental Leave Policy

The company is committed to supporting expanding families and provides comprehensive maternity benefits in strict compliance with statutory labor standards:

- **Total Duration:** Female employees are entitled to **twenty-six (26) consecutive weeks (182 calendar days)** of fully paid maternity leave for up to two surviving children (12 weeks for subsequent children).
- **Leave Scheduling:** Up to eight (8) weeks may be taken prior to the expected delivery date, with the remainder taken post-delivery.
- **Pre-Natal Care & Miscarriage Support:** Up to six (6) weeks of paid leave is provided in unfortunate events of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, supported by medical reports.
- **Flexible Return-to-Work:** Following the completion of statutory maternity leave, employees may request modified work hours or work-from-home arrangements for up to 90 days, subject to mutual role feasibility.
- **Paternity Leave:** Spouses/partners are entitled to **ten (10) business days** of paid paternity leave within the first 6 months following childbirth or legal adoption.

2. EMPLOYEE BENEFITS & ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

2.1 Comprehensive Benefits Package

The company provides a market-competitive total rewards package designed to safeguard health, enhance financial security, and promote continuous professional growth:

- **Group Comprehensive Health Insurance:** Medical coverage up to \$50,000 (or local currency equivalent) covering inpatient hospitalization, day-care procedures, and pre-/post-hospitalization expenses.
- **Dependent & Family Coverage:** Option to enroll spouse and up to two dependent children under the group health policy.
- **Life & Accidental Disability Cover:** Group term life insurance equal to 3x the employee's annual basic salary.
- **Retirement & Pension Fund:** Mandatory statutory retirement contributions matched with an optional corporate provident / 401(k) match up to 5% of basic salary.
- **Professional Development Stipend:** Annual allowance of \$1,200 for approved industry certifications, conferences, and technical courses.
- **Wellness & Ergonomic Allowance:** Annual reimbursement of up to \$400 for gym memberships, mental wellness subscriptions, or home-office ergonomic setup.

2.2 Eligibility & Vesting Criteria for Benefits

Benefit Program	Eligibility Threshold	Conditions & Coverage Specifications
Health & Medical Cover	Day 1 of Employment	Applies immediately to all regular full-time staff upon onboarding document verification.
Dependent Medical Cover	Post 3-Month Probation	Available upon confirmation. Additional premium subsidies apply for regular full-time employees.
Education & Upskilling Stipend	6 Months of Service	Requires prior written approval from Department Head; involves a 1-year service retention clause.
Corporate Retirement Match	12 Months of Service	100% employer match up to 5% of monthly base compensation with progressive 3-year vesting.
Parental / Maternity Leave	80 Working Days Service	Must have worked a minimum of 80 continuous days in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery.

3. CODE OF CONDUCT & DISCIPLINARY FRAMEWORK

3.1 Company Code of Conduct

Every employee is expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, professional demeanor, and ethical responsibility in all dealings representing the organization:

- **Equal Opportunity & Non-Discrimination:** Zero tolerance for discrimination, harassment, bullying, or intimidation on grounds of race, gender, religion, age, disability, or orientation.
- **Confidentiality & Data Protection:** Absolute non-disclosure of proprietary source code, internal architectures, client records, and business financials. All data handled under strict NDAs and GDPR/SOC2 protocols.
- **Conflict of Interest:** Employees must not engage in external commercial activities, moonlighting, or secondary employment that competes with or creates a conflict of interest with company duties.
- **Asset Protection & Information Security:** Proper utilization and safeguard of corporate hardware, software credentials, intellectual property, and internal networks.

3.2 Conduct Violations & Disciplinary Procedures

Non-compliance with company policies is investigated through a structured, objective, and fair progressive disciplinary framework:

PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINARY ACTION STAGES

1. **Verbal Counseling / Informal Warning:** For minor infractions (e.g., occasional unexcused tardiness). Documented on internal HR record for 6 months.
2. **First Formal Written Warning:** Issued upon repeated minor offenses or moderate non-compliance. Includes a mandatory 30-day corrective action plan.
3. **Final Written Warning & Suspension:** Imposed if standard behaviors are not met following prior warnings. May include unpaid suspension of 3–5 working days.
4. **Termination of Employment:** Final resolution where rehabilitation fails or in cases of summary dismissal.

GROSS MISCONDUCT — GROUNDS FOR IMMEDIATE SUMMARY DISMISSAL

Acts constituting **Gross Misconduct** result in immediate suspension, formal inquiry, and potential termination **without notice or severance pay**. Examples include: theft, fraud, violent behavior, severe sexual harassment, intentional breach of intellectual property, intoxication at work, or gross insubordination.

4. EMPLOYMENT TERMS, SEPARATION & NOTICE PERIOD

4.1 Resignation, Notice Periods & Separation Procedures

When an employee decides to separate from the company or when employment is terminated by the organization, mandatory contractual notice periods apply to ensure smooth operational handover:

Employment Status / Role Band	Required Notice Period	Operational Handover Conditions
Probationary Employees	15 Calendar Days	Applies equally to employee resignation or company termination during initial 3-month probation.
Confirmed Regular Staff	30 Calendar Days (1 Month)	Standard notice required for individual contributors and operations team members.
Senior Management & Critical Technical Leads	60 to 90 Calendar Days	Mandated for Engineering Leads, Directors, and Key System Architects to facilitate knowledge transfer.

- **Notice Buyout / Payment in Lieu:** At management discretion, the company may waive notice requirements by providing gross base pay in lieu of notice, or allow an employee to buy out remaining notice days.
- **Handover Obligations:** Separation clearances, documentation handovers, and return of all company equipment (laptops, tokens, access cards) are mandatory prior to the issuance of the Relieving Letter and Final Settlement.

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT & COMPLIANCE SIGN-OFF

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by all the rules, leave structures, employee benefits, code of conduct, and operational policies detailed in this Employee Handbook.

Employee Name (Printed):

Employee ID:

Signature:

Date (DD/MM/YYYY):